START HERE

Knowledge Ocean User Guide

Academic search, identifiers, and citation tools in one place.

1. Open the site and choose a language

Use the interface in Arabic or English. The handbook language is independent of the interface language: select it in the user-guide menu and click Download User Guide (PDF).

2. Start with a focused topic

Enter a compound, method, or research topic. Begin with five or ten results, review their relevance, and then expand the search.

3. Set options and launch

Choose sources, publication years, and document types. Decide whether you need abstracts. Start the search and wait for collection and report preparation to finish.

Daily credits

Guests receive 50 daily credits; secondary-code users receive 250. Each requested record reserves one credit, or two when abstracts are requested. One search can therefore consume several credits. Credits renew at midnight in Baghdad. VIP access has no daily credit cap.

Inside this handbook

Page 2: search settings. Page 3: sign-in and personal Elsevier keys. Page 4: results and reports. Page 5: DOI matching and citations. Page 6: history, privacy, and troubleshooting.

ACADEMIC SEARCH

Build a better query

Start broadly, then narrow the results with filters.

Choose a search mode

Use keywords for topics and terms, author mode for names written in Latin characters, and exact-phrase mode for a specific wording. Use the DOI hub for identifier lookup or title-to-DOI matching.

Combine terms with Boolean operators

AND combines topics, OR adds alternatives, and NOT excludes a term. Parentheses group related terms; quotation marks keep words together as a phrase. Avoid adding too many exclusions at the start.

Try this query

```
naproxen AND (HPLC OR spectrophotometry)
```

Set years and sources

Enter a valid starting and ending year. Choose comprehensive search to aggregate sources or a single database for comparison. Scopus requires VIP access. Providers can impose their own request limits and access conditions.

Separate scope from document type

Scope chooses papers, books, or both. Document type selects reviews, meta-analyses, original research, books, or conference papers. Enable preprints only when you intend to include manuscripts before peer review.

Abstracts and title filtering

Abstract mode includes abstracts supplied by source metadata; some records have none. Strict title filtering can exclude relevant studies, so turn it off if results are sparse. The requested count is a target; time limits and provider restrictions may produce fewer results.

ACCESS & KEYS

Sign in and use your Elsevier key

Your database API key is separate from your platform access code.

Sign in with your access code

Open Sign In at the top of the page and enter your VIP or secondary code. This handbook contains no default or personal access codes. Avoid guessing: five consecutive invalid attempts cause a temporary 24-hour IP ban.

Optionally enter an Elsevier API key

Paste your own key into the optional field in the sign-in dialog. Choose Save Key in Browser, or save it when sign-in succeeds. You can update or save the key without re-entering your access code while your signed-in session remains active.

When the key is used

For VIP searches, the saved personal key replaces the platform key for Scopus requests. Scopus is also included in comprehensive searches when a key is available. Supplying an Elsevier key does not give a guest or secondary-code user VIP privileges.

Saving and removing the key

The key stays in the same browser after reopening the page. It does not automatically sync to another device or browser. Remove Key clears it; signing out alone does not. If browser storage is blocked, the interface explains that the key is available only for the current session.

How the key is handled

The browser sends the key to the application over HTTPS, and the server forwards it to Elsevier for the search. It is not saved in search-task records, the search database, or reports, and it does not replace another user's key. Never publish credentials in GitHub or public screenshots.

If Scopus rejects the request

Check that the key is valid, Scopus access is enabled, and its usage allowance is available. Elsevier access may require a subscription or institutional entitlement. An API key alone does not guarantee every record or full-text article.

RESULTS & REPORTS

Review before you reuse

The application collects metadata and formats it for inspection.

Read the task status

Status messages show collection and report preparation. A search may finish below the requested count if too few eligible records are available. Stopping a task can preserve records already collected; stopping before any result is found produces no report.

Explore the results

Check the title, authors, year, journal, and source. Filter the list to preprints, books, reviews, or open-access records, or search within the results by title, author, or journal.

Verify the classifications

Labels are derived automatically from provider metadata. The absence of a preprint label is not proof of peer review, and an open-access label does not guarantee a direct PDF link. Verify the publisher and publication type before relying on a record.

Download your results

After completion, select the download control. Guests normally receive a PDF report; VIP users may receive a ZIP package containing reports and citation exports. Open the downloaded file to check its contents.

Understand what is included

Reports contain record metadata, links, and available abstracts when requested. They are not copies of the publisher's full-text articles. Follow the DOI or source link to read an article under the access rights available to you.

Credits and repeated requests

Invalid requests are rejected before charging credits. Unused credits are refunded when fewer records are returned, and a failed export refunds the reservation. Resubmitting while your task is active resumes that task rather than starting a duplicate.

IDENTIFIERS & CITATIONS

From a title to a verified DOI

Match the bibliographic record, not only its similarity score.

Look up a DOI directly

Open the DOI hub and enter an identifier or its full link. Review the returned title, authors, journal, year, and links. Some fields may be missing from the original source.

Match a paper title

Choose title-to-DOI matching and paste the full title where possible. Compare the highest results with the expected authors, year, and journal before accepting a DOI. A similar title can belong to a different paper or a preprint version.

Copy and export citations

Result cards offer APA citation copying or BibTeX data when available. Use BibTeX with a reference manager or LaTeX. Verify names, title, issue, pages, and DOI before submitting academic work.

Handle incomplete metadata

A record can have unknown authors, an unavailable year, or no DOI. Check the publisher page for missing details. Do not invent an identifier or infer facts absent from the source.

Follow full-text links

Links may lead to a publisher page or an open repository. Some articles require a subscription or institutional sign-in. A DOI or Elsevier key does not automatically grant permission to download a paywalled article.

A practical analytical-search workflow

Start with the analyte and analytical technique. Refine years and document type. Review the title, abstract, and publisher, verify the DOI, and export the reference. Save local copies of the reviewed report and citations.

HISTORY & HELP

Recover your work and troubleshoot

Keep local copies of files you will need later.

Use package history

Refresh history to see your files, then reopen results or download a report. Access is tied to your browser session; clearing site data or losing a session can affect guest-file access. Report files are deleted automatically after 48 hours.

Service data

Search queries, results, and task data are stored on the server for history. Quota and IP data support usage limits and sign-in protection. Deleting report files does not necessarily delete every database record at the same moment.

No results or slow searches

Reduce AND conditions and exclusions, turn off strict title filtering, and widen years or document type. Try another source or a direct DOI. Providers can throttle requests or become temporarily unavailable; retry later after a provider or timeout message.

Credits exhausted or a download denied

Check your remaining balance, requested record count, and abstract option. Credits renew at midnight in Baghdad. For old files, use the browser and session that created them. If retention has expired, repeat the search.

A key is not retained

Use the same browser and allow site storage. Private browsing or clearing site data can remove the key. Reopen Sign In and save it again when needed. Use Remove Key when you do not want a key to remain on a shared device.

Before you finish

Download important reports and verify your citations. Remove the personal key if it should not remain in the browser. Select Log Out at the top of the site to end the session and return to guest mode. Download the handbook in the other language from the same menu.